standard was specifically applied in the League of Nations in order to globally advance the Christian colonial consciousness of the West, especially in colonised countries including Bharat, through the medium of national constitutions.

Importantly, the timeline shows a significant overlap between (*a*) the Paris Peace Conference proceedings, and the debates relating to that in the British Parliament and (*b*) the preparation of the Montford Report for a constitutional scheme for Bharat, and the passing of Government of India Act of 1919. Therefore, the preparation of a constitutional framework for Bharat in 1918–1919 must be viewed in the larger context of framing and enforcing national constitutions to universalise European coloniality and Christian universalisms.

The Paris Peace Conference, Nation-States and Civilised Nations

Much before Samuel Huntington spoke of the ‘Clash of Civilisations’ in the 1990s,[7] it had already taken place when European colonisers sought to impose their Standard of Civilisation on colonised societies, which defined the in-group, namely civilised nations, and the out-group, namely the ‘uncivilised’ or ‘not-civilised nations’. As discussed in Chapter 4, the Standard of Civilisation has its roots in Westphalian thought and became the basis for international relations since it stood for a certain degree of commonality between ‘nations’, such as their ‘common interests and values, commonly binding rules, and common institutions’. While between two European nations it was easier to apply the standard given a shared Christian civilisational mooring, between European nations and non-European societies, the application of the standard was a function of the power imbalance, which enabled the European to impose the Christian Standard of Civilisation as a pre-requisite for the establishment of bilateral relations. Whether motivated by the transactional need for reciprocity or driven by coloniality, the standard came to signify the civilising attitudes of European nations. Implicit in this position is the requirement of a ‘nation-state’, that is, only a group that was a ‘nation’ could aspire to become a ‘nation-state, which, as explained in the first section of this book, was a direct consequence of the Westphalian model as well.

Therefore, calling a nation ‘civilised’ is a secularised way of labelling it a ‘Christian nation’ or a Europeanised nation that has organised itself on the